

Kathleen Alves Costa

Atlanta, GA



RESEARCH INTERESTS

Natural Language Processing for online threat assessment and violence prevention, with a focus on social media discourse and the ethical application of AI in high-stakes contexts.

EDUCATION

University of Arizona — *M.S. in Human Language Technology*
Expected December 2025

Georgia State University — *B.A. in Applied Linguistics*
Graduated May 2024
Focus: Adult Language Instruction

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Generative AI Chatbot Developer

Community School of the Arts Foundation – *Remote* | *July 2025 – Present*

- Supported AI curriculum and generative content initiatives for K–12 arts education, integrating LLM-based tools and Canvas LMS for enhanced learning experiences
- Developed and documented AI-driven educational resources using NLP , prompt engineering, AWS, React, HTML, and GitHub
- Collaborated remotely via Slack and Zoom, maintaining project deadlines, version control, and adherence to data privacy and inclusive teaching practices

Language Specialist / Quality Assurance Specialist

Innodata, Inc. – *Remote* | *May 2024 – Present*

- Provided linguistic expertise and QA for AI training data in Portuguese and English
- Audit linguistic annotations for accuracy and compliance with quality standards

- Manage multiple annotation projects simultaneously with consistent on-time delivery

ESL Instructor

The Learning Center – Marietta, GA | Sep 2023 – Dec 2023

- Designed and delivered English instruction to Spanish- and Portuguese-speaking adult learners
- Emphasized phonology, syntax, and discourse-level comprehension in line with L2 acquisition theory
- Integrated communicative and task-based approaches to improve fluency

Activities Intern – Intensive English Program (IEP)

Georgia State University – Atlanta, GA | May 2023 – July 2023

- Organized conversation-based cultural events and language practice sessions
- Designed multilingual promotional materials
- Acted as liaison between instructors and international students to improve engagement

RESEARCH & PROJECTS

Brazilian Portuguese TTS with Tacotron2

- Built a full TTS pipeline using Tacotron 2 and FastSpeech trained on ~11 hours of speech
- Analyzed mel-spectrograms to evaluate interpretability of prosodic patterns.
- Trained on HPC cluster over 2,500 epochs

Esperanto ASR with DeepSpeech

- Demonstrated adaptability of ASR to low-resource languages—relevant to cross-lingual information extraction
- Compared greedy vs. beam decoding; achieved better accuracy with non-greedy methods

- Focused on model intelligibility and error analysis to better understand phonetic decoding in low-resource settings

Webcam Dictation Assistant

- Integrates OpenCV, Tesseract OCR, and VITS for real-time screen-to-speech conversion
 - Designed for accessibility (visually impaired, dyslexia, second-language users)
 - Includes automatic language detection and translation
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TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages & Scripting:** Python, Bash, Perl, Prolog, Git, Linux command line
 - **NLP & ML Tools:** spaCy, NLTK, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas, BeautifulSoup4
 - **Speech Technology:** Tacotron 2, FastSpeech, DeepSpeech, GlowTTS, Whisper, VITS
 - **Software:** Praat, Shell scripting (HPC clusters), Canva, Excel, Jupyter Notebook, Docker, LaTeX, R Markdown, R Studio
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LANGUAGES

- **English:** Native
- **Portuguese:** Fluent
- **Spanish:** Intermediate